

Adrian Erlikhman

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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- Fjor Venture Capital** — Investment Intern 2024 – Present
- Due diligence on 20+ early-stage AI startups; authored 10+ full investment memoranda (market sizing, competitive positioning, technical architecture, founder evaluation) for partner-level decisions with Managing Director Tatiana Janko. Led screening of the Y Combinator S25 batch; drafted monthly LP updates.
- Alliance for SoCal Innovation** — Venture Outreach & Pipeline Intern 2024 – 2025
- Built the Alliance’s 250+ firm investor database (VCs, angel syndicates, accelerators); led a backend redesign of pipeline infrastructure with the Chief Innovation Officer; mapped the SoCal life-sciences ecosystem and developed founder toolkits.
- Kiddom** — Data Science Mentorship · with *Director of Data Science Flora Xu* 2026
- Ongoing one-on-one mentorship with the data-science lead of a K-12 edtech curriculum platform: applied ML methods on educational content and product data, production data workflows, and how a data team ships inside an ed-tech company.

VENTURES & CIVIC TECHNOLOGY

- AI/ML Literacy Initiative (AIML-LI)** — Co-Founder & Lead · *aiml-initiative.org* 2023 – Present
- Architected a 12-week, project-based K-12 AI curriculum (supervised/unsupervised learning, neural networks, NLP, RL, AI ethics) with 16+ classroom-ready units: Colab notebooks, teacher guides, student packets, assessments. Piloting in LAUSD with the Directors of Educational Technology and Secondary Learning; pursuing A-G elective accreditation.
 - Organizing a one-day AI summit and hackathon for 500+ LAUSD high school students (fall 2026) with speakers from Google DeepMind, Microsoft, and MongoDB; supported by aiEDU, MongoDB for Educators, Confluent, Discovery Education, Arm, Jane Street, Render, PhET, and YC Startup School.
 - Mentored by Amir Zohrenejad (Data Herald, YC W21) and Philo Juang (Google DeepMind); presented at the LAUSD Innovation Expo alongside Google, Microsoft, and Canva; invited to the \$10,000 LAUSD Student Innovation Challenge.
- Safe Routes LA** — Co-Creator · *safe-routes-la.github.io* 2026
- Safety-scored walking and transit route planner covering 668 Los Angeles public schools: prices street crime block by block (431,599 scored blocks) from LAPD incident, streetlight, and transit open data, then surfaces the bus ride that cuts a student’s exposure by up to 80% — fully client-side, no server. **3rd place internationally, Code for Transportation** (Young Coders’ Sphere), cited for real-world impact potential.
- SafeJew** — Co-Founder · *JFEDLA Teen Innovation Grant Recipient* 2024 – Present
- Live map of antisemitic incidents across Greater LA, in production at safejew.org: 800 plotted in LA (100 individually sourced with a citable link on each, the rest from the ADL H.E.A.T. Map) plus 594 across 33 campuses nationwide. A daily GitHub Action scrapes news and geocodes it through a dependency-free LA gazetteer written for this. Next.js, TypeScript, Supabase on Vercel; rebuilt as V2 for a Hillel International pitch.

RESEARCH

- Comparative LLM Stylometry (CompLLM)** — First Author · *Advisor: Philo Juang, Google DeepMind* 2026
- Under review, NeurIPS 2026 Workshop** (submitted Aug 2026).
- Explains why frontier language models fail to recognize their own writing and why misattributions collapse onto GPT-4o and Claude — a “prestige sink” effect significant at χ^2 $p \approx 0.0001$.
 - Built the data pipeline: 200 responses across five frontier models (GPT-4o, Gemini, Claude, Grok, DeepSeek) from a 40-prompt bank stratified by readability and difficulty, plus a held-out bank for out-of-sample validation.
 - Engineered 16 interpretable stylistic features; trained a depth-limited decision tree with SHAP attribution to surface plain-English rules for what makes text “look like” a given model. Validated with χ^2 , Cohen’s κ , permutation tests, difficulty-stratified ANOVA, and a Wilcoxon debiasing-prompt intervention to probe causality.
- Cross-Lingual LLM Stylometry (LangLLM)** — First Author · *Co-author: Philo Juang, Google DeepMind* 2026
- Poster submitted to MIT URTC 2026** (IEEE Undergraduate Research Technology Conference).
- A separate question from CompLLM: does a model’s stylistic fingerprint survive when it writes in a different language? Measures how the same five models diverge across Chinese, Russian, Spanish, Japanese, Hindi, and a Turkic language.
 - Designed a translation-free protocol — every prompt authored natively in its language, never translated — with independent per-language collection via OpenRouter, so cross-lingual differences reflect the models rather than the prompts.
- Legatum Prosperity Index Robustness Audit** — Co-Author · *advised by Stanford researcher Abdulla Kerimov*
- Resampled the index’s 1/12 pillar weights, normalization, and aggregation rule over 10,000 draws under three priors, with a Sobol’ variance decomposition across fourteen inputs. Rankings hold globally (median Spearman ≥ 0.987) but are locally soft: the median country’s 90% rank interval spans 22 places. **Accepted, Journal of High School Science.**

- Advanced Mathematics Research** · PhD Candidate Kirill Kovalenko 2022 – Present
- Induction, number theory, combinatorics, and game theory applied to algorithmic problem-solving and computational mathematics.

SELECTED TECHNICAL PROJECTS & COMPETITIONS

- Regime-Aware Portfolio Optimizer** — Gaussian HMM regime detection with RL-driven allocation and volatility-regime frameworks. **LSTM Equity Forecaster** — TensorFlow time-series model on rolling-window NYSE data, benchmarked against ARIMA and linear regression. **FinBERT Market-Sentiment Pipeline** — news and social sentiment mapped to market events. **Fraud-Detection System** — Random Forest / Gradient Boosting for rare-event classification with precision-recall optimization.
- Y Combinator Startup School 2026** — admitted at a sub-5% acceptance rate with \$30,000+ in partner credits; completed the company-building program end to end (validation, user discovery, go-to-market). **Citadel High School Terminal 2026 (Correlation One)** — Finalist; three-person team; wrote “dunerscore,” a Python tower-defense strategy iterated through replay post-mortems to the finals. **eDNAtlas — 1st place, Decode the Ocean Hackathon** (Lovable × United Nations, 2026): live map turning environmental-DNA data into a plain-language health score for coastal sites, with Darwin Core downloads.

EDUCATION

- Los Angeles Center for Enriched Studies (LACES)** — Class of 2027 Los Angeles, CA
- GPA 5.2 weighted / 4.0 unweighted · SAT 1520 (Math 770 / EBRW 750) · 11 AP courses completed, 6 more senior year, plus dual-enrollment linear algebra and programming (CS 119, Python).

LEADERSHIP & ATHLETICS

- Competitive Fencing (Épée)** — USA Fencing A-rated (highest U.S. rating); Team USA, 2026 Pan American Championships, Bogotá (6th); Region 4 Champion; RJC winner; peak U.S. ranking 17th; Top 32 Division I National Championships; Top 8 Senior Team, Summer Nationals; Top 8 / Top 16 North American Cups; 3× All-American First Team; 3× All-Academic First Team. In active recruitment with MIT.
- Jewish Student Union** — President (2023–Present). Grew and lead a 50+ member club with weekly programming and guest speakers in partnership with NCSJ; organized a schoolwide Holocaust Remembrance assembly featuring a survivor with StandWithUs; run antisemitism-education programming for the whole school.
- STEMsters** — Co-Founder & President (2022–Present). Built a student volunteer program placing 30+ LACES students in 4 elementary schools; designed hands-on coding, robotics, physics, and engineering lessons (model cars, mechanical hands) for underserved youth; manage scheduling, lesson planning, and volunteer training.
- AIML Club at LACES** — Co-Founder & President; the weekly club (9 members, grades 9–12) that grew into AIML-LI.

HONORS, SERVICE & COURSEWORK

- National Merit Semifinalist · AP Scholar with Distinction · JFEDLA Teen Innovation Grant · Decode the Ocean Hackathon, 1st place · Code for Transportation, 3rd place · Citadel Terminal Finalist · YC Startup School (\$30k+ credits) · SIFMA Stock Market Game, top 5% statewide (solo entrant) · MTAC Piano, Level 9 candidate, five state-honors exams.
- Certiport ITS certifications: Software Development, Cybersecurity, Python, Data Analytics, AI, HTML/CSS · Kaggle × Google Generative AI Intensive · Coursera Deep Learning Specialization (Andrew Ng) · NVIDIA Deep Learning Fundamentals.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Python, TypeScript/JavaScript, scikit-learn, TensorFlow/Keras, PyTorch, pandas, NumPy, SHAP, Next.js, React, Supabase/PostgreSQL, Git, LaTeX · NLP/stylometry, time-series, HMMs, decision trees, hypothesis testing, cross-validation · English, Russian (fluent), Spanish (intermediate).